

Week 5 Milestone 2: Benchmark

 by Alwin Lin

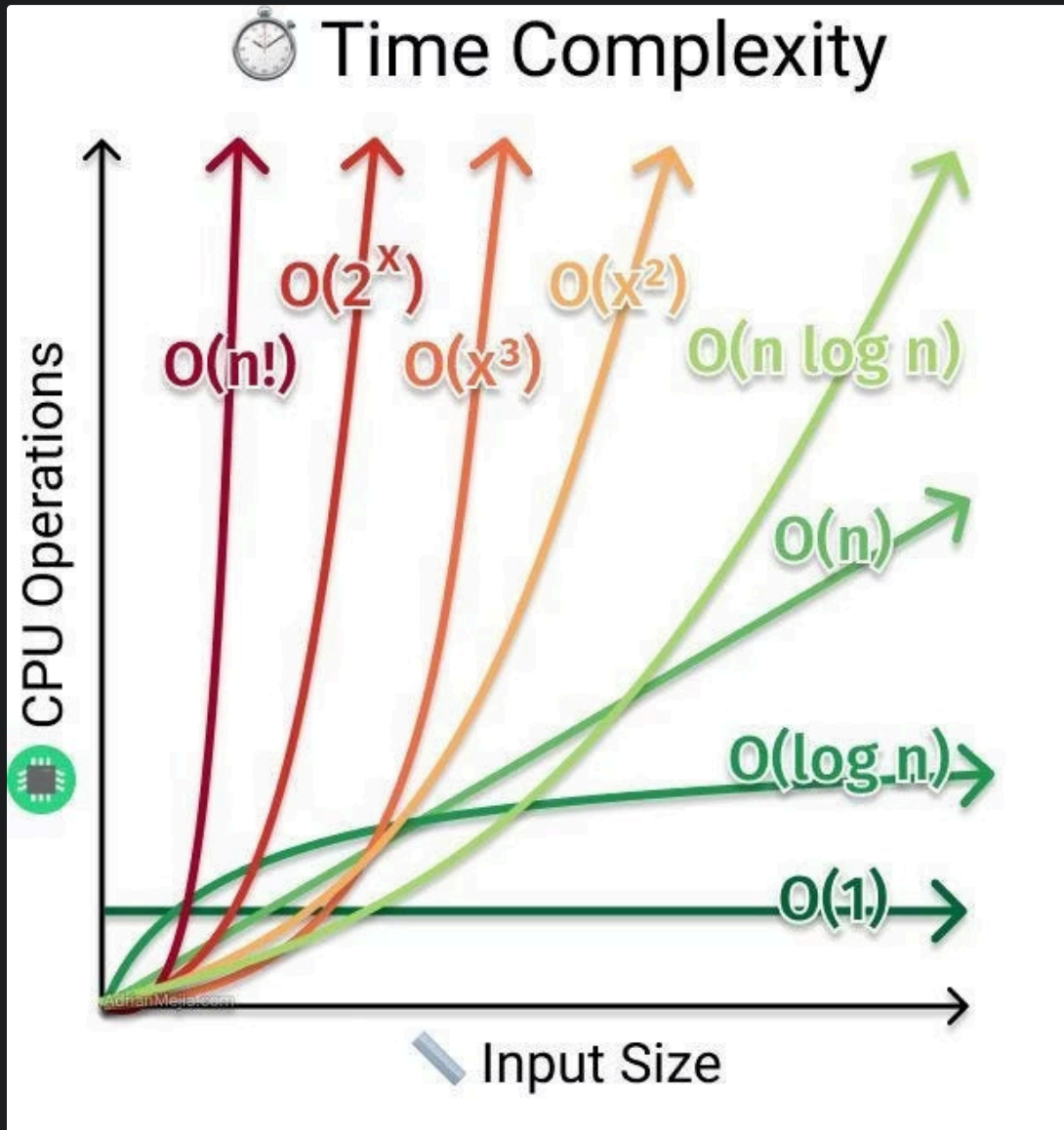
Why these two new problems

Problem	LLM's natural attempt	Why it fails	What the fix looks like
Two Sum Exists	$O(n^2)$ nested loops	TLEs at $n = 50\,000$	$O(n)$ hash set / single pass
Fibonacci	$O(2^n)$ naive recursion	TLEs at $n > 35$	$O(n)$ DP or memoization

Correct is not enough

Type	Meaning	Explanation
AC	Accepted	Correct AND fast AND small
TLE	Time Limit Exceeded	Correct but too slow
MLE	Memory Limit Exceeded	Correct but uses too much RAM
WA	Wrong Answer	Incorrect output
RE	Runtime Error	Crashed / Error

Quick Talk with $O(n)$



TLE, MLE, and the judge

[Naive Approach] Generating all Possible Pairs – $O(n^2)$ time and $O(1)$ space

```
for i in range(len(nums)):
    for j in range(i + 1, len(nums)):
        if nums[i] + nums[j] == target:
            return True
return False
```

TLE, MLE, and the judge

[Better Approach 1] Sorting and Binary Search – $O(n \times \log(n))$ time and $O(1)$ space

```
seen = set()
for num in nums:
    if target - num in seen:
        return True
    seen.add(num)
return False
```

Problem reveal + harness walkthrough